

Lila Anderson Lewis Middle School

Delegation from Allied Garden San Diego

The Republic of Latvia

United Nations Convention Against Corruption

Topic B: Cybercrime and Corruption

Section I

In the year of 2018, Russia attacked Latvia's government and social media platforms, this happened repeatedly. The attacks targeted the Central Election Commission and government institutions all while an election was taking place. The attacks were thought of as espionage and intended to alter the votes of the election. Russia was unsuccessful and the election went on. Tallinn Manual 2.0 on the International Law Applicable to Cyber Operations, Rule 92 should have made Russia's attacks illegal but it didn't fall under an act of cybercrime due to there not being an ongoing act of armed conflict between the two countries. Russia's actions were discussed for a long period of time regarding whether it was considered cybercrime as none of Latvia's people were injured or affected in the process so it was thought not to be. After the repeated attacks, the trust between the two neighboring countries deteriorated. (1)

Since the Ukrainian war, Latvia's cyber attacks have increased by 30%. Originally, the attacks were financially motivated, but now the attacks target the government and infrastructure. The same hacker groups that have been trying to hack Ukrainian software are doing the same for Latvia. The deputy manager of Latvia's Computer Emergency Readiness Team told the media that what the hackers are trying to achieve is unclear. Not much damage from the attacks has taken place, nothing more than publicity. (2)

1:<https://www.fpri.org/article/2020/06/cyberwarfare-in-latvia-a-call-for-new-cyberwarfare-terminology/>

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2: <https://therecord.media/latvias-cyberspace-faces-new-challenges-amid-war-in-ukraine/>

Section II

Latvia has taken a few measures towards the cybercrime attacks. On September 17, 2019, Latvia's Cabinet of Ministers approved the report 'Cyber Security Strategy of Latvia for 2019-2022. This signifies how the CSP (Cyber Security Policy) will try to boost public awareness of threats and cybercrime. The CSP will also provide public engagement and strengthen the resilience of cyber security systems. The policy has five action areas: enhanced cyber security and manageable digital security risks; resilience of ICT systems; better universal access to strategic ICT systems and services; public awareness, education, and research; international cooperation; rule of law in cyberspace and cyber-crime prevention. (3)

The 2014-2018 cybersecurity strategy of Latvia set five priority areas of action: 1. Governance and Resources of Cyber Security. 2. Rule of Law in cyberspace and reduction of Cyber Crime. 3. Crisis management. 4. Awareness raising education and research. 5. International cooperation. (4)

3: <https://www.mod.gov.lv/en/news/latvia-approves-new-cyber-security-strategy-2019-2022#:~:text=The%20strategy%20describes%20cyber%20security,awareness%20of%20threats%20in%20cyberspace.>

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Section III

Latvia believes to extinguish cybercrime in Latvia would be to educate people about the problem. If people are more aware of the situation they might not be the victim of these scams and crimes. Another idea would be to have security alerts that notify the people when there are potential security threats. It could be as simple as a banner popping up on your screen saying that the software isn't secure. Overall, if citizens were to have more of these opportunities and advantages to know that there is a potential that their system can get hacked, it might prevent these problems in the future.

Latvia's solution is to have better-encrypted sites so Latvia doesn't get attacked or hacked as often. The government should also run drills to prepare and prepare themselves on how they would respond. Since hackers usually attack private businesses that work for or with the government in order to gain access to government information, certain standards could be set for private businesses to follow if they would like a contract with the government. Some standards could include employee training or anti-virus software.

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Sites Used:

- https://eucpn.org/sites/default/files/document/files/LV_1.pdf
- <https://www.fpri.org/article/2020/06/cyberwarfare-in-latvia-a-call-for-new-cyberwarfare-terminology/>
- <https://www.enisa.europa.eu/topics/national-cyber-security-strategies/ncss-map/lv-ncss>
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- <https://www.mod.gov.lv/en/news/latvia-approves-new-cyber-security-strategy-2019-2022#:~:text=The%20strategy%20describes%20cyber%20security,awareness%20of%20threats%20in%20cyberspace.>